

Display & Video Retail Insights

Global Measurement & Insights team
Germany - June 2026

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Retail forecast & trends

Economic conditions continue to influence the purchase process

2.8%

DE inflation rate

Inflation remains relatively contained in Germany, but with prices still elevated it continues to influence shopper sensitivity

+0.20pp

EU inflation impact from geopolitical risk

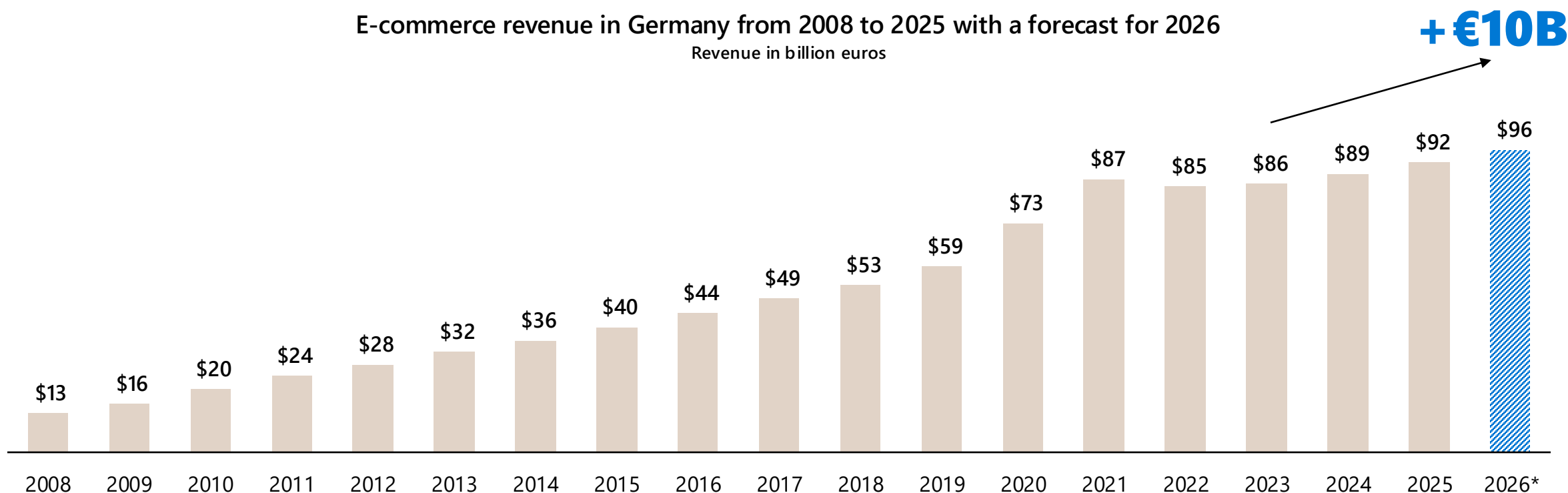
Geopolitical risk adds +0.20pp to inflation in 2026, before falling to +0.03pp by 2028, making the impact more of a near-term bump than a lasting shift

AI is already mainstream in shopping journeys, with most consumers using AI tools to discover, compare, and evaluate products before purchase



German e-commerce is expected to keep on growing

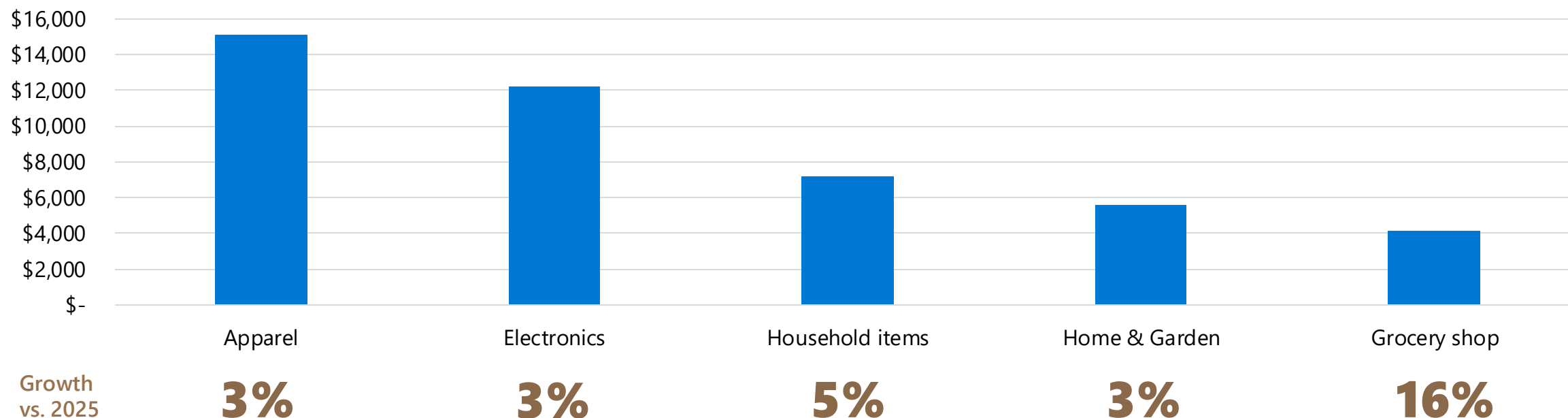
E-commerce revenue in Germany from 2008 to 2025 with a forecast for 2026
Revenue in billion euros



The next wave of ecommerce growth is being driven by high momentum categories

E-commerce revenue in Germany in 2025 by segment

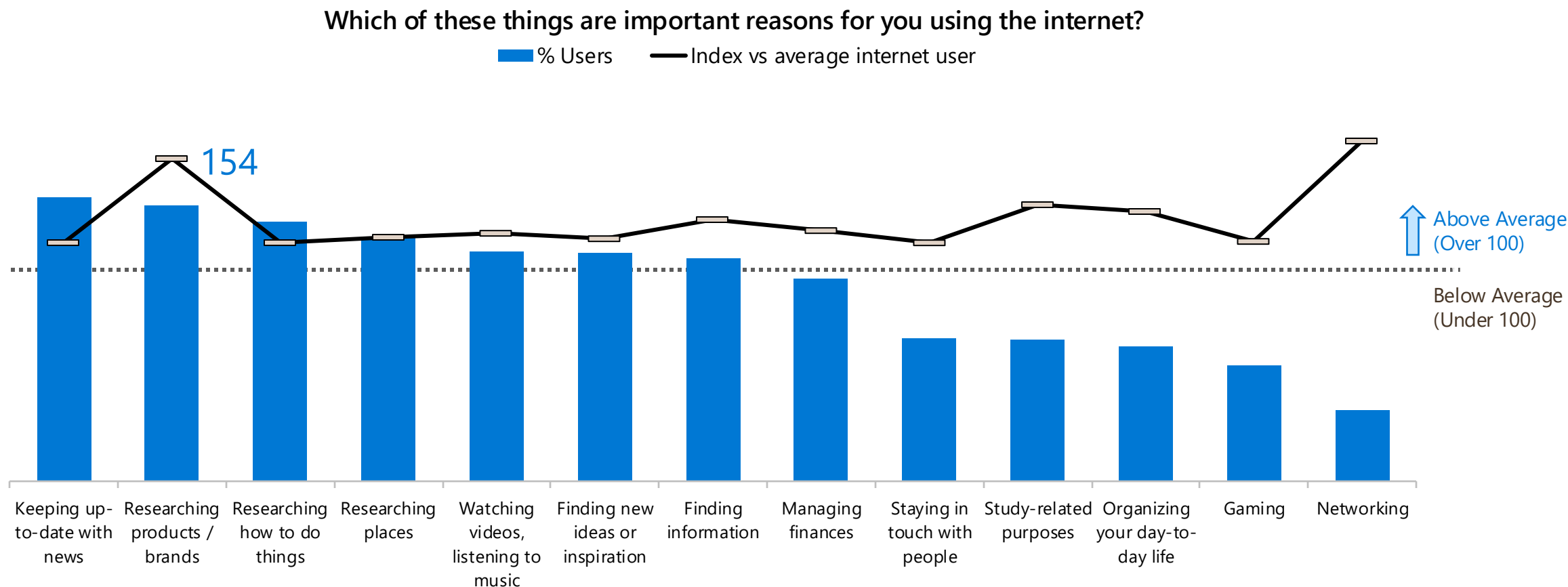
2025 Revenue in million euros (**Blue Bars**) vs. 2025 vs 2024 YOY Growth (**Brown Text**)





Who is behind the cart?

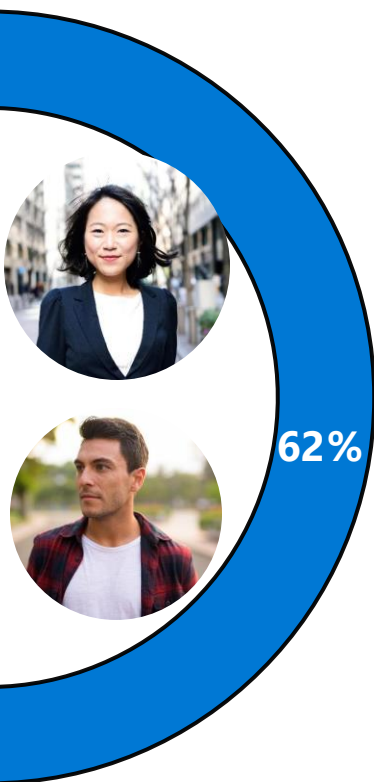
German users have 1.5x higher likelihood to shop online over the average internet user



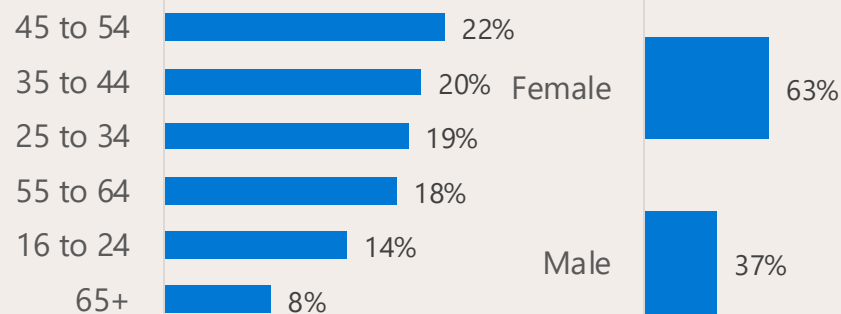
More than half of Microsoft users go online with the intention to browse and evaluate before making a purchase



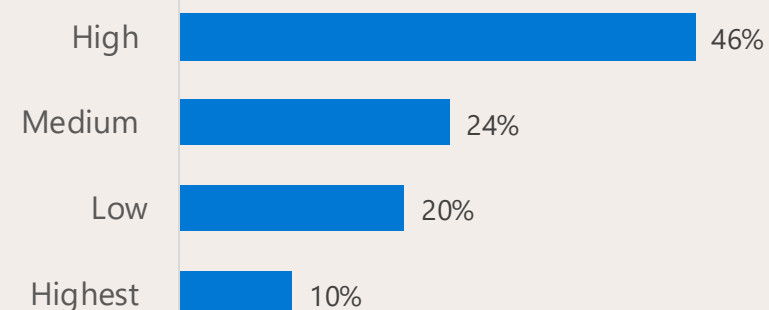
What does a Microsoft Media high intent shopper look like?



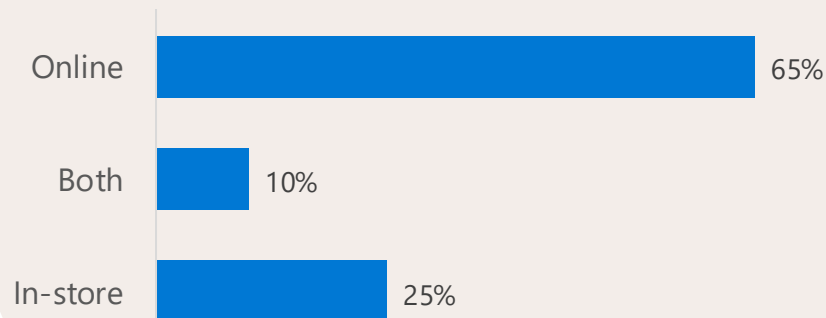
Demographics



Income segments



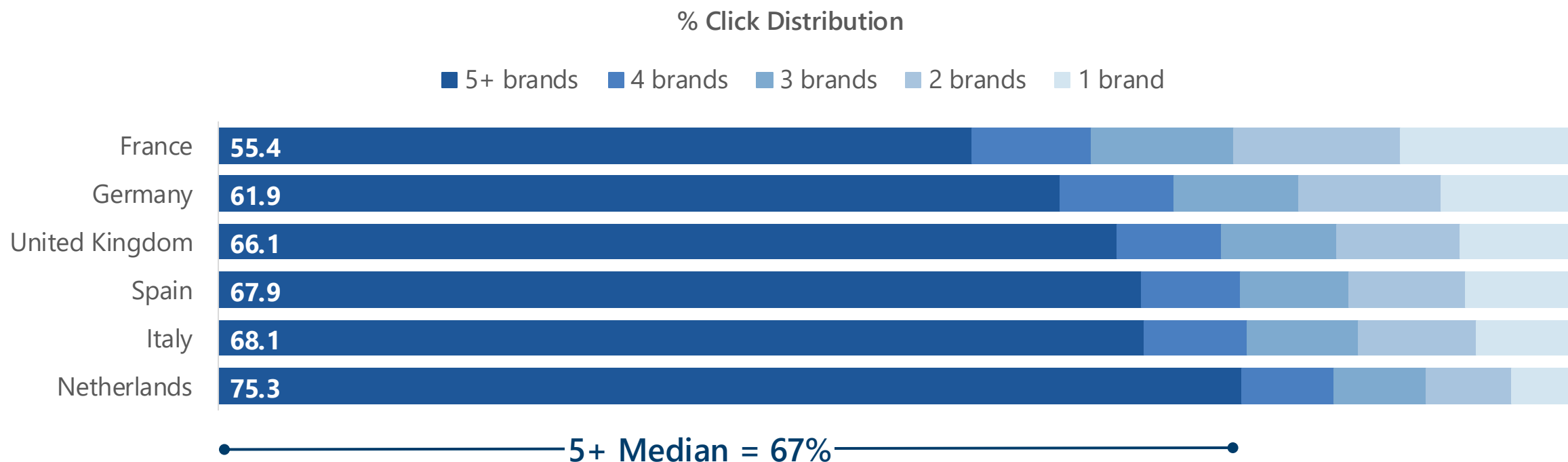
Black Friday sales



Online shopping behavior

Users are **10.2x** more likely to be Brand-loyalists, and **5.9x** more likely to be Online Activists, making them especially valuable for brand discovery, advocacy, and conversion-led social commerce environment

Most EMEA shoppers consider 5 or more brands while shopping during the holidays



Microsoft properties connect with millions of German consumers across everyday digital moments



For **18%** of users,
Microsoft Media
properties are the final
touchpoint before
visiting retail brand sites





Consumer decision journey

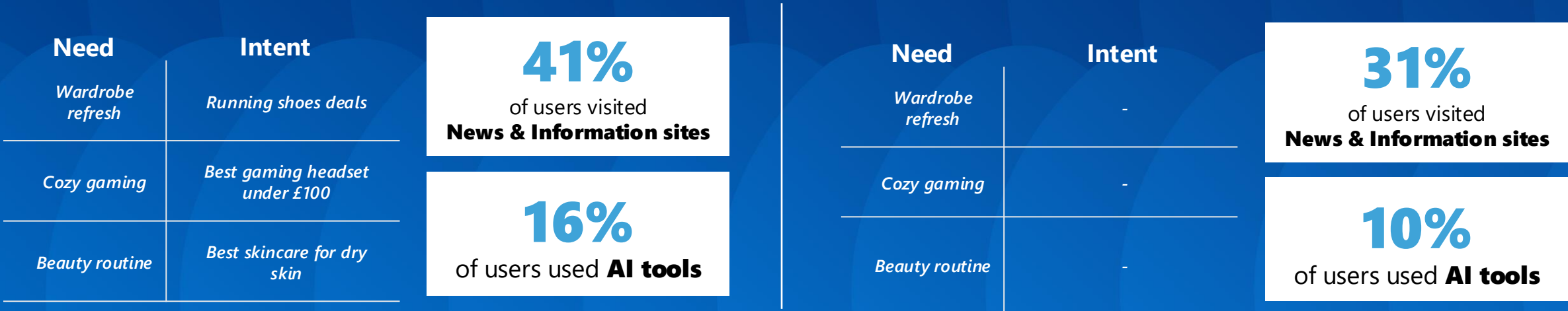
High intent retail users keep validating decisions in content rich environments throughout the journey

High intent users

Intent driven shoppers that not only explore products but also compare prices, reviews, and deals before making purchase decisions

Discovery users

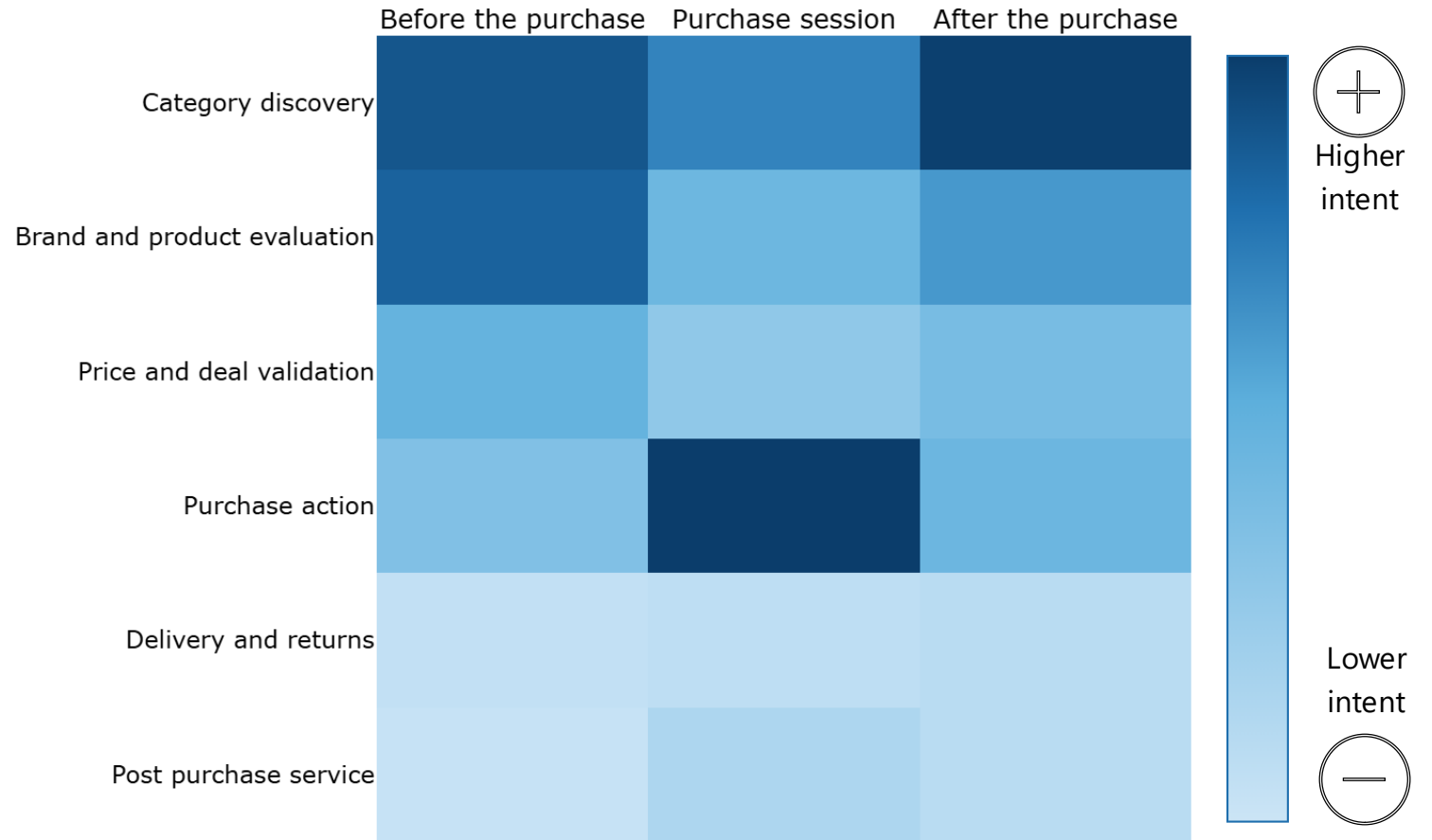
Holiday shoppers actively exploring gift ideas, trends, and product inspiration across categories



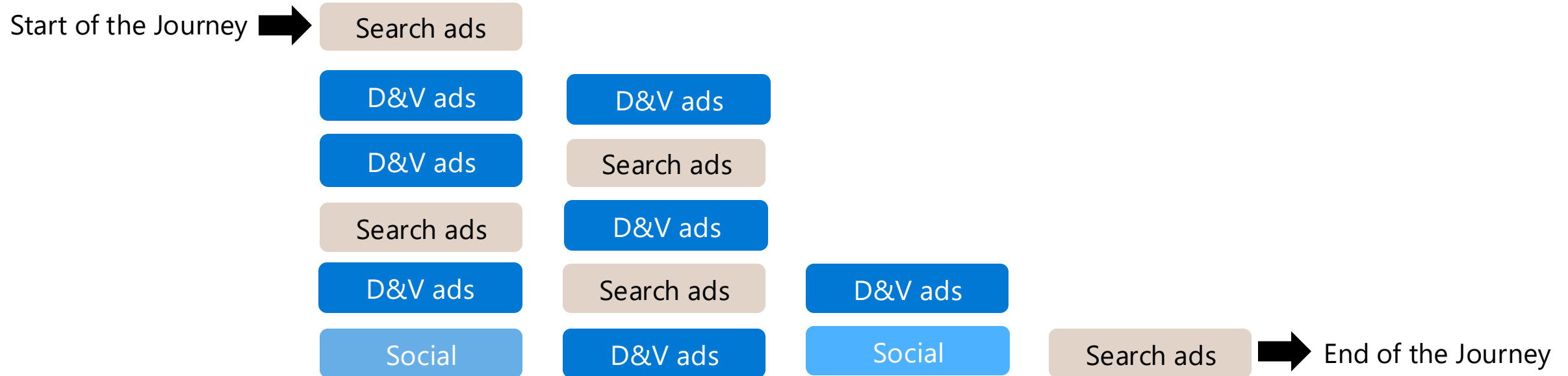
The journey does not end after the purchase

Rather than transitioning into post-purchase behaviour, buyers immediately return to discovery, evaluation and brand evaluation within the same Retail category, with these activities reaching even higher levels after conversion

Consumer decision journey before, during and after purchase



Building on the user journey, we ran a multi-touch attribution model during the last Retail peak, in 2025, to understand how different channels contribute to the journey



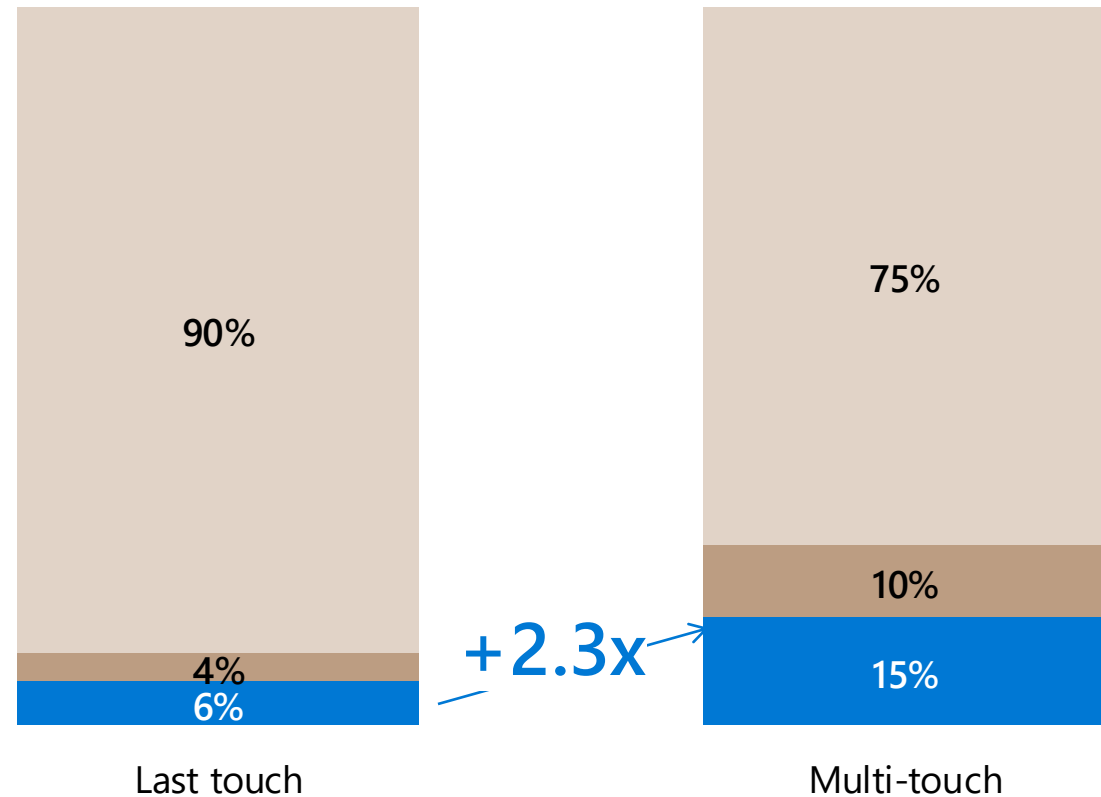
Display & Video drive 15% of total conversions

When measured via multi-touch attribution (MTA), Display & Video report significantly greater impact than last-touch models show.

MTA proves that Search is simply not enough, and that Display & Video are critical drivers to the overall user journey.

% of conversions, last click and multi-touch attribution

■ Display/Native/Video ■ Social ■ Search



Content consumption Insights

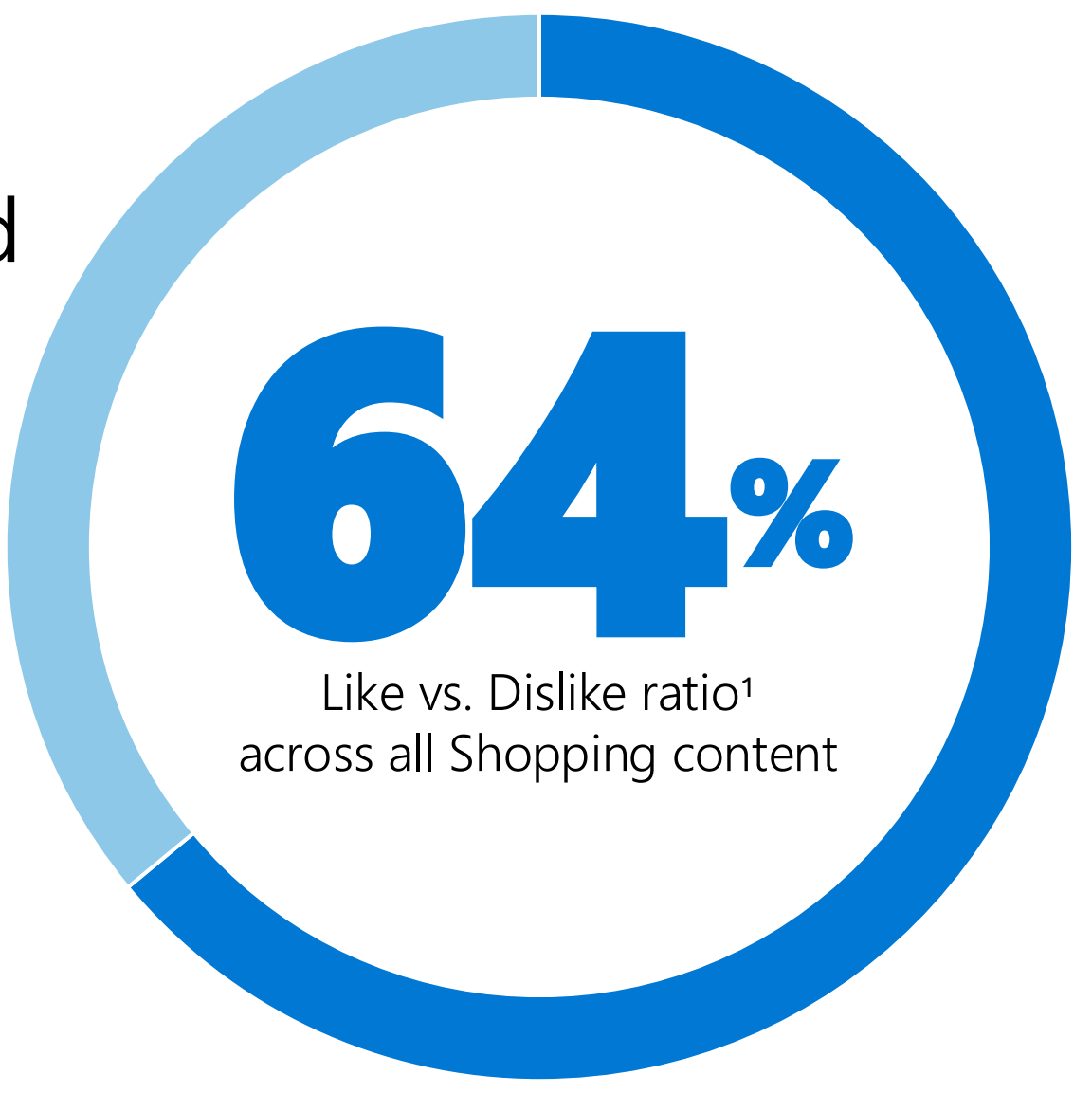
Shopping content is spread across MSN key Verticals and Topics

Natural Discovery

Discovery happens natively during natural content consumption as users engage with shopping content across a variety of sites, rather than a dedicated retail space

The Power of AI

AI-driven personalisation surfaces relevant shopping content based on user context, amplifying engagement and guiding users toward retail decisions



64%

Like vs. Dislike ratio¹
across all Shopping content

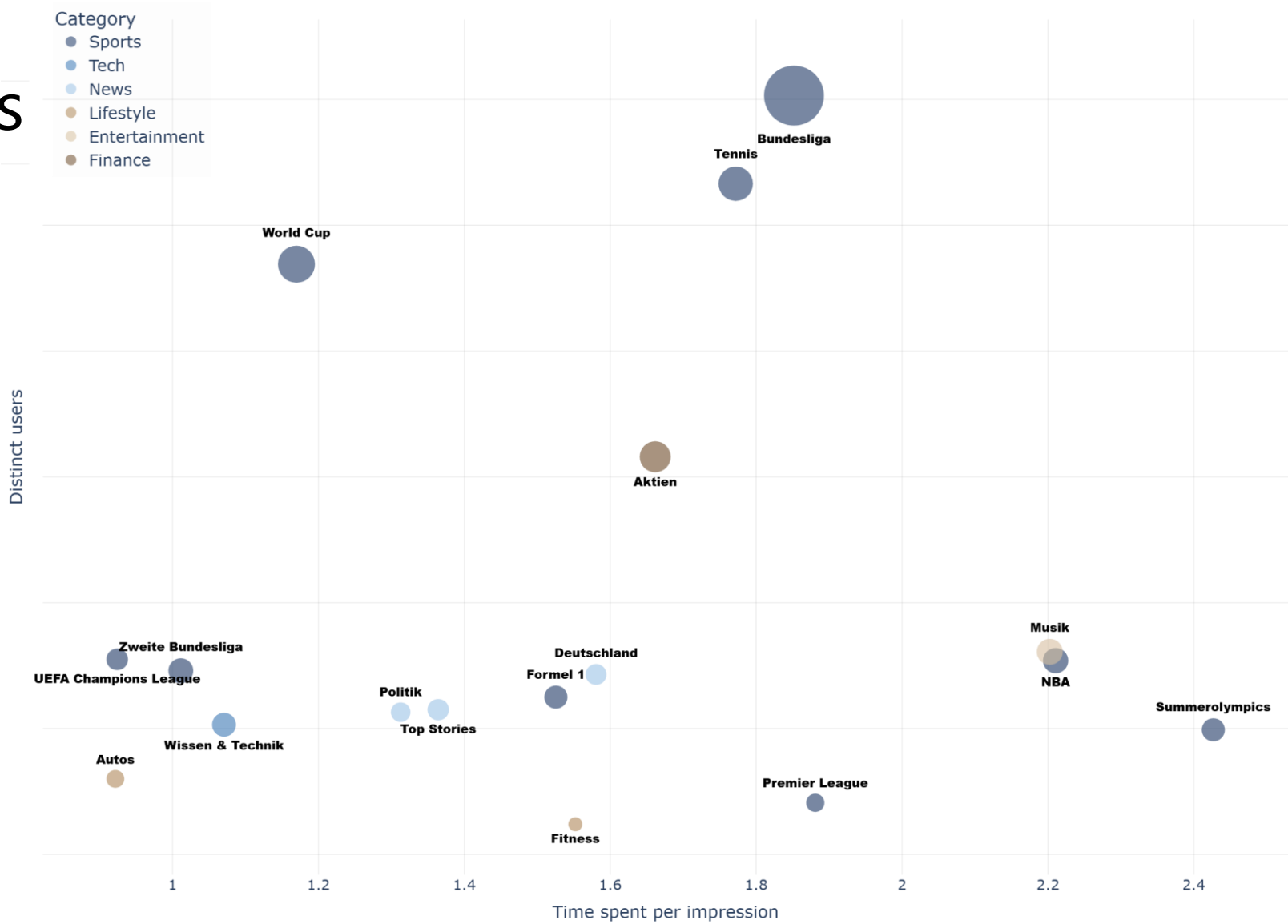
Shopping intent forms outside of dedicated shopping spaces

Intent Beyond Retail

Shopping intent is formed within high-engagement content environments such as Sports and global News, rather than within dedicated retail spaces, indicating that consumer demand is shaped long before users enter commerce platforms.

Topics Drive Demand

High-impact topics act as discovery engines, where large audiences combined with deeper engagement are influenced in their product consideration and brand choice.

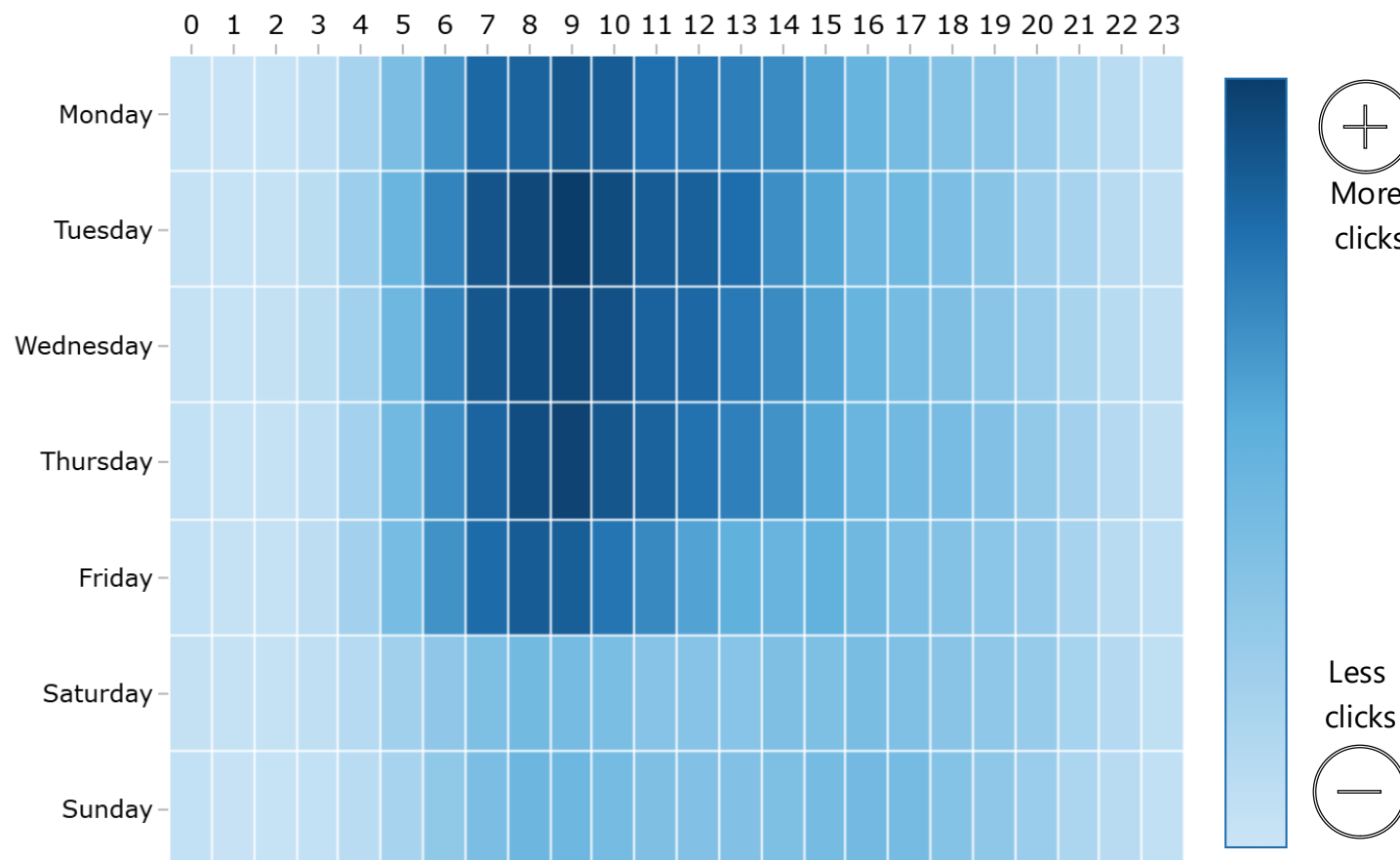


Early morning drives peak shopping engagement

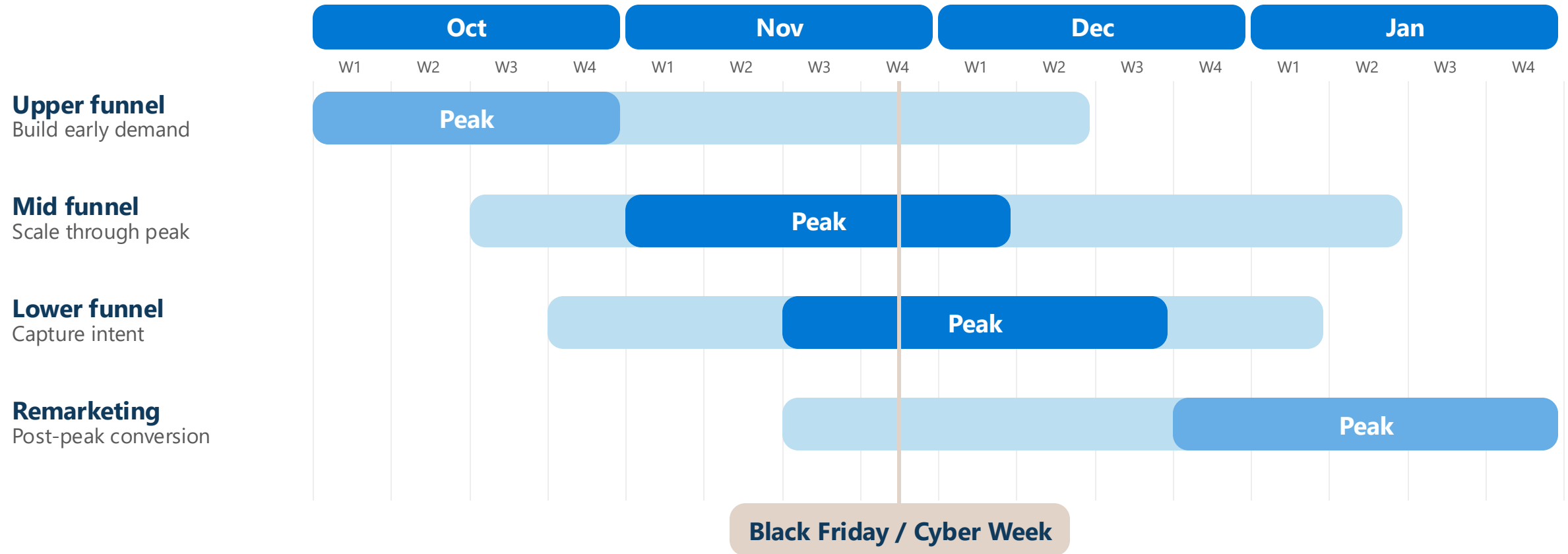
Engagement with shopping-related content remains present daily but intensifies during the first “*business hours*” of the day

This suggests that users are most receptive to discovery and consideration during active daily browsing periods rather than at isolated shopping moments nor during the weekends

Clicks by day of week and hour of day for shopping-related MSN topics



The holiday activation calendar: what to run, and when



Takeaways & Recommendations

01

The user journey is not linear- Display & Video play a crucial role

- ✓ Measure performance using multi-touch attribution to measure the full contribution of upper and mid-funnel channels
- ✓ Maintain always-on strategies during key moments, including post-purchase

02

Peak engagement is driven by daily behaviour patterns

- ✓ Optimise dayparting strategies to prioritise high-engagement hours
- ✓ Extend planning beyond retail sites into high-engagement content environments where retail demand is formed